Team Roadmap & Launch Budget

From working demo to a live app on Google Play and the App Store

PREPARED FOR

RAYNO team meeting

DATE

11 October 2026

FUNDING NEEDED

US$35,000 recommended (US$12,000 lean minimum)

STORE FEES

Google Play US$25 once · Apple US$99 per year

Figures marked "estimate" are planning numbers. Check every price with the provider before paying.

Summary for the team

RAYNO already works as a demo on iPhone and Android. To launch for real we need a server (accounts, shared listings, real chat), a licensed payment partner, the two app-store accounts, and about 6 months of team and marketing money. The recommended budget is **US$35,000**; a lean launch is possible from about **US$12,000**.

Question	Short answer	Page
1. Funding and store fees	US$35,000 recommended. Stores: Google Play US$25 once, Apple US$99 every year (US$124 in year 1).	4
2. How we get paid	Commission on protected payments, paid boosts, store plans, delivery share, ads later. The payment partner splits each payment into our business account.	5
3. Keeping the app running	About US$4,500–5,000 a month after launch (team, server, SMS, marketing). The server alone starts at about US$25/month.	6
4. Total to launch	Lean ≈ US$12,000 · Recommended US$35,000 (includes 10% contingency).	7
5. Roadmap	4 phases over 12 months: Build, Launch Freetown, Expand to 4 towns, Scale. Break-even ≈ month 10 (estimate).	8

Already done

- Brand, logo, app icon and splash screen.
- Working app: Home, Market, Search, item pages, Services, Stores, Deals, I Need It Now, Chat, Cart, Checkout, Orders, Profile, Settings.
- Checkout screens for Orange Money, Afrimoney, Visa/Mastercard and cash on delivery (demo, no real money yet).
- All 16 districts of Sierra Leone with towns and Freetown neighbourhoods.
- **New today:** real sign-in with phone number + SMS code (Supabase), ready for the team to test.

Is the earlier notice still correct?

Yes. It is important, and these are the points to rely on. I checked the main facts online today; the rest are planning estimates.

Point	Status today	What it means for us
Google Play fee US$25, one time	Confirmed (multiple 2026 sources)	Pay once by debit/credit card (no prepaid cards).
Apple fee US$99 per year	Confirmed	Must renew every year or the app is removed from the App Store.
New personal Google accounts: 12 testers for 14 days	Confirmed by several 2026 guides; organisation accounts with a D-U-N-S number are reported exempt	Either recruit 12 testers now, or register the company and open an organisation account.
Apple requires account deletion inside the app	Apple rule since 2022	Already in Settings > Delete account. Must delete server data too once live.
Supabase Pro US$25/month	Confirmed (plus usage above the included limits)	Free plan for testing; Pro at launch.
SMS sign-in codes cost money	About US$0.13–0.25 per SMS to Sierra Leone (third-party price lists)	1,000 sign-ups ≈ US$130–250. Use free test numbers for team testing.
Payment partners, grants, market figures	Not yet checked	Contact providers and confirm before applying or signing.

1. Funding and store fees

Store fees are small. Most of the money goes to people: a developer to finish the server, field agents to sign up sellers, and marketing.

App store accounts (confirmed prices)

Store	Cost	Notes
Google Play Console	US$25 one time	Personal account: 12 testers × 14 days before going public. Organisation account needs a D-U-N-S number (free).
Apple Developer Program	US$99 per year	Needed to publish on iPhone. Review usually takes 1–3 days. No Mac needed: Expo (EAS) builds in the cloud.
Total year 1	**US$124**	**Then US$99 per year for Apple.**

Other one-time setup costs (estimate)

Item	Estimate (US$)	Why
Company registration + business bank account	300–800	Needed for payment partners, the stores as an organisation, and funders.
Lawyer: privacy policy, terms, seller agreement	500–1,500	Required by both stores; protects RAYNO.
Domain (rayno.sl or .com) + business email	50–150 per year	Professional email and a website for policies.
Payment partner set-up	0–500	Varies by provider; ask for a quote.
D-U-N-S number	Free	For organisation developer accounts.

Funding we need: US$35,000 recommended over 12 months, or a lean US$12,000 to launch in Freetown only. Best sources: grants and competitions first (no shares given away), then local angel investors and partners. See page 7.

2. How we get paid

RAYNO is free to browse, list and chat. We earn when we add value. Customers pay through the payment partner, which automatically splits each payment: the seller's share goes to the seller, RAYNO's share goes to the **RAYNO business bank account**. As founders you earn through owning the company (profit and value) and through salaries once revenue allows.

Revenue stream	Who pays	Example price (estimate)	Starts
Commission on protected payments	Seller, per order	3% of the order (team to decide: 3% or 5%)	When RAYNO Pay is live
Boosted listings	Seller	NLe 25 for 7 days	Month 2
Store plans	Shops	Free basic · Pro NLe 250/month · Business NLe 600/month	Month 3
Delivery fee share	Buyer (in the delivery fee)	NLe 10–20 per delivery	With delivery partners
Leads for service providers	Electricians, plumbers…	NLe 5 per offer, or included in Pro	Month 4
Advertising	Local brands	By campaign	After ~20,000 users

Example: one month at month 12 (estimate)

Stream	Volume	Per month
Commission	3,000 orders × NLe 1,000 × 3%	NLe 90,000
Boosts	1,500 × NLe 25	NLe 37,500
Store plans	150 Pro stores × NLe 250	NLe 37,500
Delivery share	1,500 deliveries × NLe 15	NLe 22,500
Total		**NLe 187,500 ≈ US$8,000**

Rate used: about NLe 23 per US$ (check the current rate). Note: digital extras bought inside the iPhone app (boosts, plans) may have to use Apple in-app purchase (15–30% fee); selling them to shops by mobile money or on our website avoids this. Physical goods and services can use our own payments.

3. Keeping the app running

After launch RAYNO needs about **US$4,500–5,000 a month** (estimate). The technology is cheap; people and marketing are the main cost. The goal is for revenue to cover this by about month 10.

Monthly cost	Estimate (US$/month)	Notes
Supabase server (accounts, database, photos, chat)	25 to 100+	Free plan for testing; Pro US$25/month at launch, more as users grow.
SMS sign-in codes	50–300	≈ US$0.13–0.25 per SMS; grows with sign-ups. Cheaper providers or WhatsApp codes can cut this.
Apple fee (spread over the year)	≈ 8	US$99 per year.
Domain, email, small tools	10–30	
Developer (maintenance + new features)	1,000–2,000	Contract or salary.
Support and moderation	300–600	Answer users, check reports, approve verified badges.
Field agents (seller onboarding)	400–800	Freetown first, then one per district town.
Marketing	1,000–1,500	Social media, radio, posters, referral airtime.
Payment partner fees	% per transaction	Paid out of our commission; ask partners for rates.

What the team does every week to keep it healthy

- Check reports and suspicious listings daily; approve or reject verified-badge requests.
- Answer support chats and resolve order problems within 3 working days.
- Ship small fixes instantly with over-the-air updates (EAS Update); bigger updates go through store review.
- Watch the numbers: active sellers, listings, users, orders, disputes per 100 orders.
- Daily automatic database backups (Supabase Pro).

4. Total amount needed to launch

Two options. The lean option launches in Freetown with a very small team; the recommended option funds 12 months, four district towns and a 10% buffer.

Item	Lean (US$)	Recommended (US$)	What it pays for
Development	4,000	10,000	Server, SMS login, payments integration, staff dashboard, store publishing
Marketing launch	2,500	8,000	Social media videos, radio, posters, referral airtime
Seller onboarding	2,000	5,000	Field agents in Freetown (+ 4 towns in recommended)
Operations and support	1,000	4,000	Support/moderation staff, phones, data
Legal, registration, store accounts	1,500	2,500	Company, lawyer, Apple US$99, Google US$25
Server, SMS, payment set-up	1,000	2,000	Supabase, SMS codes, partner fees
Contingency	—	3,500	10% for the unexpected
Total	**≈ 12,000**	**35,000**	

Why US$35,000: in the plan, the deepest point of cumulative loss is about US$23,700 in month 9; the rest is buffer.

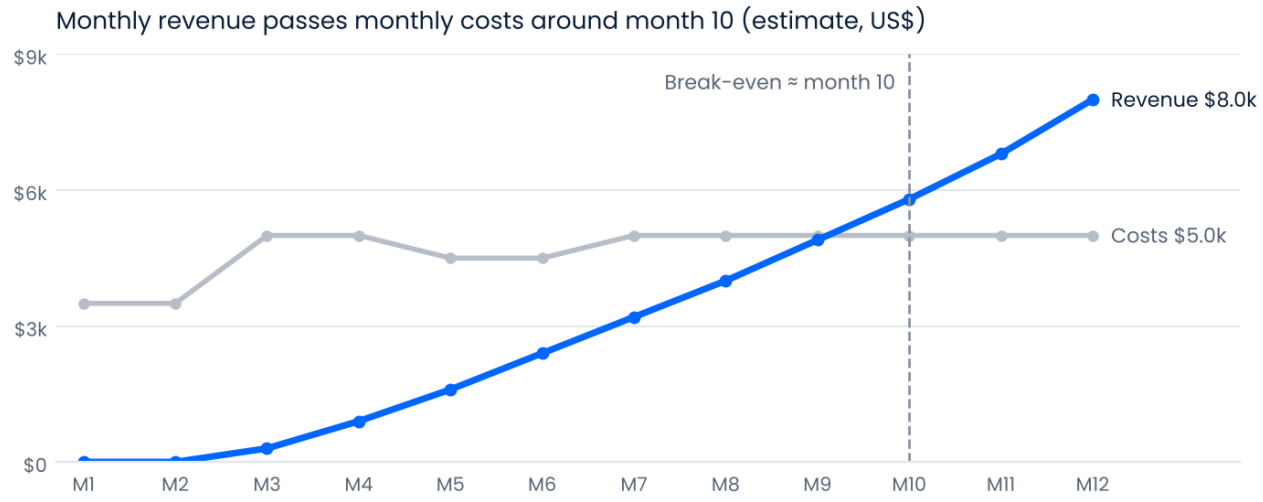
Where to raise it (check each programme's current rules and deadlines)

Source	What it offers	When to apply
Tony Elumelu Foundation Entrepreneurship Programme	Training, mentoring, seed grant (historically ≈ US$5,000)	Next open call
Local innovation hubs and government programmes (e.g. DSTI)	Training, small grants, investor connections	Now: ask what is open
Africa's Business Heroes	Prize competition for founders with traction	After launch
Google for Startups Accelerator: Africa	Mentoring and cloud credits (usually no cash)	After launch
Angel investors (local business people, diaspora)	US$5,000–50,000 for a share of the company	After 200+ sellers sign up
Strategic partners (banks, wallets, phone distributors)	Money, marketing or services	Any time

5. Roadmap

Each phase starts when the one before meets its “go when” condition. Dates count from the month the funding arrives.

Phase	When	What we do	Go when
1 · Build	Months 1–2	Finish the server (accounts, listings, chat, photos); sign the payment partner; staff dashboard; sign up 200 sellers in person; closed testing with 12+ testers	App approved on both stores
2 · Launch Freetown	Months 3–4	Public launch; marketing campaign; QR posters in partner shops; switch on RAYNO Pay	1,000 orders
3 · Expand	Months 5–6	Bo, Kenema, Makeni and Koidu: one agent per town; bus-park and courier delivery partners	5 towns live
4 · Scale	Months 7–12	Store plans and boosts; advertising and partnerships; 20,000 users	Break even



Planning estimate, not yet based on quotes.

Legal and trust checklist

Based on the "20 things so your app doesn't get sued" list, adapted to RAYNO. Done = built in the app today.

#	Item	RAYNO status	Next step
1	Privacy policy	Draft in the app	Lawyer review; publish on our website (both stores need a link)
2	Terms of service	Draft in the app	Lawyer review; seller agreement
3	Refund policy	Added today	Confirm timelines with the payment partner
4–5	Cookie policy / banner	Not needed in the phone app	Needed only on our website if it uses tracking cookies
6	Form consents	Sign-in shows Terms and 18+ notice	Add tick-box consent for marketing messages
7	No unnecessary data	We ask only phone, name, town	Keep it that way; no ID numbers stored in plain text
8	Audit third-party SDKs	Expo, Supabase only; no ads or trackers	List them in the privacy policy and store data-safety forms
9–10	No dark patterns / hidden fees	Delivery fee and total shown before paying	Show the commission clearly to sellers
11	No fake reviews	Demo reviews now labelled "sample"	Delete all sample data before launch; only buyers with an order can review
12	No unsupported claims	Demo stores say "verified" as examples	Only real ID checks earn the badge
13–15	Accessibility, contrast, keyboard	Labels on buttons; large-text support; brand colours	Contrast check of small grey text
16	Business details	Placeholder in Privacy & Terms	Add registration number, address, support contact
17	Age / children's data	18+ notice at sign-in	Add an 18+ confirmation when selling or paying
18	Unsubscribe in emails	No emails yet	Add when we send marketing SMS/email
19	Licensed fonts and images	Poppins font is free (open licence). Demo product photos are NOT licensed	Replace demo photos with sellers' own photos before launch
20	Data deletion request	Settings > Delete account	Also delete server data once live

Today's meeting: agenda and SMS login test

Agenda (about 60 minutes)

1. Demo the app on a phone (10 min).
2. Test real sign-in with SMS codes together (15 min, steps below).
3. Decide: commission 3% or 5%; lean (US$12k) or recommended (US$35k) plan (10 min).
4. Assign owners: company registration, payment partner calls, seller interviews, funding applications (15 min).
5. Agree the next 30 days and the next meeting date (10 min).

How to test SMS sign-in today

1. Create a free account at **supabase.com** > New project (region: Europe West). Save the database password.
2. **SQL Editor** > paste the file **supabase/schema.sql** from the project > Run.
3. **Authentication > Providers > Phone**: turn it on. For a free test, add **Test phone numbers**, e.g. 23276123456=123456 (no SMS is sent; that number always uses code 123456). For real SMS, connect a Twilio or Vonage account.
4. **Project Settings > API**: copy the Project URL and the anon / publishable key (never the service_role key).
5. On the laptop, in the app folder, create a file named **.env** (copy .env.example) and paste both values.
6. Run **npx expo start --clear**, open the app, Profile > **Sign in with phone number**.
7. Check that each tester appears in Supabase under Authentication > Users.

Owners and next 30 days

Task	Owner	Due
Interview 30 sellers; 20 letters of intent		
Collect sellers' own product photos (with permission)		
Start company registration; open business bank account		
Get quotes from 2 payment partners (Orange Money, Afrimoney, cards)		
Google Play account; recruit 12+ testers		
Apply to open grant programmes		

Sources checked on 11 October 2026

Store fees: choicely.com/tutorials/how-much-does-it-cost-to-publish-an-app; playcode.io/blog/how-much-does-it-cost-to-publish-an-app
Google Play 12 testers: extendsclass.com (closed testing requirement 2026); testerscommunity.com (Google Play 12 testers policy 2026)
Supabase pricing: schematichq.com/blog/supabase-pricing; makerkit.dev Supabase pricing 2026
SMS prices to Sierra Leone: sent.dm Sierra Leone SMS pricing (Twilio, Infobip, Sinch, Plivo)
Everything else (payments, grants, market, costs) is from planning estimates and general knowledge; verify before use.